

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A Q 9 4

♥ 5

♦ Q 9 7 5

♣ Q J 10 6

♠ K J 6

♥ Q J 8 6 2

♦ 6 4 2

♣ 9 3



♠ 10 8 5 3

♥ 9 4

♦ K J 10

♣ K 8 7 2

♠ 7 2

♥ A K 10 7 3

♦ A 8 3

♣ A 5 4

West

North

East

South

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

eliminate one of the ♠ losers - that would at least get you to down only 1.

Or, if West holds the ♠Q and East the ♠A then leading up to the ♠J would also eliminate one ♠ loser. But this play has another advantage - if West should happen to hold **BOTH** the ♠A and ♠Q then leading up to the ♠J will actually let you make the contract. So you win the ♣A, pull two trumps, then play a ♠ to the ♠J. If that wins, back to your hand with a trump and play your other ♠ to the ♠K.

Some times you don't really expect to make a contract - this is one of those times.

But you should still ask yourself if there is some distribution that will allow you to be successful. And if there is, just assume that distribution and boldly play the cards out.

You open 1♥ and partner jumps to 4♥. You pass.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♣Q.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♣Q.

Losers: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 1 : Total = 5

The ♣ losers are shown as 1 since you will always be able to ruff a ♣ in dummy.

North's precipitous leap to 4♥ was made partly in hopes of making the contract, and partly as a preemptive bid to shut the opponents up. So it wouldn't be a surprise to land in an unmakeable contract. However, this one has a slim chance. The only suit you might make something of is ♠s. If West holds the ♠A then leading up to the ♠K would

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 7

♥ J 10 9

♦ 9 4

♣ Q 8 6 5

♠ K 8 5 3

♥ K 6

♦ J 6 5 3

♣ A 7 2



♠ 9 2

♥ A Q 8 4 3

♦ 10 8 7 2

♣ 9 4

♠ A 6 4

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A K Q

♣ K J 10 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♦

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

♣Q so naturally you will finesse West. You dare not let West get into the lead since he can lead through dummy's ♥K. If East gets the lead with the ♣Q, he cannot hurt you.

Win the first trick with the ♠A. (**DO NOT HOLD UP, WEST MAY SWITCH**). Play the ♣K then ♣J, letting it ride if not covered. East can win the ♣Q but cannot lead a ♥ without giving you a trick. You win whatever else he returns and make your 9 tricks. Of course you must be careful to unblock the ♦ A K Q while you still have a dummy entry to the ♦J.

This is another hand where you want to keep a particular defender off lead. In this hand it is West who is the Danger hand.

Be on the lookout for this type of situation because many times you have a finesse that can be made either way. So you finesse into the Safe hand.

Balanced, 17 points. You open 1NT. Partner's response is 2♣.

Partner's 2♣ is Stayman. You have no 4-card Major to show so you bid 2♦. Partner now says 3NT and you pass.

South plays 3NT. West leads ♠Q.

South plays 3NT. West leads ♠Q.

Winners: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 4 : ♣ 2 : Total = 8

The only thing better than being good is being lucky! You are very lucky that you didn't get a ♥ lead - now you must take advantage of your good luck.

You only need one more winner, and the ♣ suit is your best bet. You can finesse either defender for the

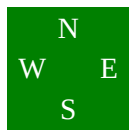
Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q J 10 7 4 3		♠ -
♥ 5		♥ K 6 3
♦ Q 3		♦ K J 10 9 4 2
♣ Q 7 5		♣ 10 9 6 2

♠ A 9 6 2		♠ 8 5
♥ A 8		♥ Q J 10 9 7 4 2
♦ A 8 7 6		♦ 5
♣ A 4 3		♣ K J 8



West	North	East	South
3♠	4♥		3♥
All Pass			

4♥ by South

West probably has a 7-card suit to overcall at the 3-level, so if you play the ♠A East will ruff and one of your winners will disappear. So don't play the ♠A. Duck and let West win the trick while East shows out as expected. West will lead the ♠Q and you duck again. So West will lead the ♠J and you duck one more time, but now you can ruff in your hand.

Lead your ♥Q and finesse, East winning the ♥K. East will probably return a ♦ which you win in dummy. Play the ♥A. Then ruff a ♦ to get back to your hand and pull any trumps left out. Play a ♣ to dummy's ♣A and at long last play dummy's ♠A and discard your ♣ loser.

You always had 10 winners in this hand, as long as one of them didn't disappear.

To make sure the ♠A didn't disappear you had to hold it until East no longer had a trump.

You estimate your hand has 6 playing tricks. That is reasonable for a preemptive 3♥ bid. West overcalls 3♠ and partner bids 4♥. Everybody passes.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♠K.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♠K.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 1 : Total = 3

This looks way too easy. If the ♥ finesse works and the ♣ finesse works you could make 6. It is when things look too easy that you should look for danger! What if you play the ♠A and East ruffs. What if East also gets a trick with the ♥K and West gets a trick with the ♣Q. What with your ♠ loser you would be down 1.